

Standard Operating Procedure ***Belt/Disc Sander***

General International Model 15-015M1 Belt/Disc Sander

The 15-015M1 is an industrial combination sander used for surfacing, edge squaring, and thinning material. The machine utilizes a high-torque 1 HP motor to drive a 6" x 48" sanding belt and a 12" sanding disc simultaneously. This sander is a rough shaping tool; it is not intended for precision finished cuts or dimensioning critical tolerances

Potential Hazards

- **Mechanical**: Point of operation (abrasive surfaces), pinch points between tables and disc/belt, and power transmission points.
- **Operational**: Intense heat at the workpiece, fine dust particulates, and high noise levels.
- **Chemical**: Cleaning sticks or solvents used for belt maintenance.
- **Electrical**: Exposed wiring, malfunctioning switches, or unexpected startup.

Personal Protective Equipment (PPE)

PPE Item	Requirement
Tie Back Hair & Secure Loose Items	**Tie back long hair and secure loose clothing that could get caught in rotating parts. Remove rings, watches, and other jewelry.**
Eye/Face Protection	**Wear ANSI Z87.1-compliant safety goggles. A face shield may be necessary to protect from high-velocity dust and debris.**
No Gloves Advised	**STRICTLY PROHIBITED: Gloves can get caught in the abrasive surface or between the table and disc. Use push sticks or boards and follow the "4 inch" rule**
Hearing Protection	**Required:** Operating noise levels under load exceed 90 dB; earplugs or muffs are mandatory.
Protective Clothing	Close-fitting protective clothing, such as a shop apron, is encouraged.
Footwear	Appropriate enclosed footwear must be worn at all times.



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Before Use

- **Workspace**: Know the location of start and stop switches, and keep the sander area free of tools and scrap material.
- **Condition Report**: Report any unsafe conditions, such as torn sanding belts or loose tables, to the shop supervisor immediately.
- **Table Clearance**: Ensure the gap between the worktable and the sanding disc/belt is no more than **1/16 inch** to prevent stock from being pulled into the machine.
- **Belt Tracking**: Verify that the 6" x 48" belt is centered on the rollers and tracking correctly before turning on the power.
- **Dust Collection**: Ensure the dust collection system is active and the gates are open.
- **Maintenance**: Unplug the power before adjusting belt tension or changing abrasive media

During Use

- **Focus**: Concentrate on the task at hand; avoid distractions. Most injuries occur when the operator is not paying full attention.
- **Startup**: Allow the sander to reach full speed prior to applying stock.
- **Directional Safety**: **Always** sand on the downward-travel side of the disc (typically the left side) to keep the workpiece pressed against the table. Sanding on the upward-travel side will cause kickback.
- **Feed Pressure**: Do not force stock into the abrasive. Let the grit remove the material at a natural rate.
- **The "4-Inch" Rule**: Keep hands at least 4 inches away from the abrasive surface. Use a push stick or board to push small or irregularly sized pieces of stock.
- **Round Stock**: Never attempt to sand round stock unless it is securely fastened in a V-block or specialized jig.
- **Table Contact**: Hold the stock flat on the table prior to and during the entire duration of the cut.
- **Stalling**: If the machine binds or the belt stops, turn the power off immediately and wait for a complete stop before investigating.

After Use

- **Shutdown**: Shut off the power and ensure the machine is ready for the next person.



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- **Coast-Down**: Wait for the belt and disc to completely stop on their own—**do not** attempt to use your hands to stop them.
- **Cleanup**: Sweep or use a shop vacuum to collect any resulting debris. **Avoid cleaning with compressed air** to prevent injury or driving dust into the motor bearings.
- **Hygiene**: Wash hands and exposed skin thoroughly after completing work to remove abrasive dust and particulates.

Emergency Equipment and Procedures

- **Reporting**: Report all incidents to the shop supervisor, including injuries, equipment damage (e.g., torn belts), and near misses.
    - **Location**: Know the location of the nearest emergency stop, eye wash station, and fire extinguisher.